

Marketing Report

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Abstract

This report investigates marketing as a potential career path for the rising generation through both primary and secondary research. An interview with Eric Baxley, Chief Marketing Officer at HOAi, offers firsthand insight into the skills, responsibilities, and ethical considerations of the profession. Secondary sources from CareerOneStop (2025) and ONET Online (2025) provide data on job outlook, required education, writing expectations, and related qualifications. The findings highlight marketing as a dynamic field that blends creativity, strategy, and monotonous work. The report presents an overview of the compensation and conditions associated with the profession to be used as a guide to academics in career planning.

Background

Marketing is the career I intend to pursue. My interest in the field began with a thesis I wrote on athletic sponsorships. That project introduced me to the strategic and creative aspects of promotion, which led me to explore marketing more seriously as a career path. As I researched college majors and completed a career assessment, marketing consistently aligned with my strengths and interests. The field involves promoting products, services, or ideas to targeted audiences through various channels, including advertising, digital media, and public relations. It requires a blend of creativity, analytical thinking, and communication skills. Writing plays a central role in marketing, as professionals must craft persuasive messages, develop campaign materials, and communicate clearly with clients and the public. Whether producing ads, reports, or strategic proposals, writing is essential to shaping brand identity and driving engagement. Before conducting further research, I understood marketing as a dynamic field focused on influencing consumer behavior and building relationships through storytelling and strategy. This report explores the responsibilities, job prospects, required education, and writing expectations in marketing, along with a look at ethical concerns emerging in the industry. By combining insights from professional interviews and academic sources, I aim to determine whether marketing is the right career path for me and what skills I will need to succeed.

Methods

To better understand the marketing profession and the role of writing within it, I conducted primary research via an interview with Eric Baxley, Chief Marketing Officer at HOAi, a startup focused on AI-driven software. I selected Mr. Baxley because of his extensive experience in both large corporations and startup environments, as well as his leadership in marketing strategies, product positioning, and team development. His background includes an

undergraduate degree in Electrical Engineering with a computer concentration, followed by an MBA, which sparked his interest in marketing. His career path and current role made him a valuable source for insight into the skills, responsibilities, and communication demands of the field. I asked Mr. Baxley a total of thirteen questions on November 10, 2025. The material covered primarily dealt with the type of work/writing completed daily, the ideal career path, and the specific skills and knowledge required.

For my secondary research, I began at the VGCC Learning Resource Center's (2025) *Researching Careers* guide, which provided a list of credible resources for career exploration. From there, I followed a link to CareerOneStop's (2025) "Explore Careers" page, a resource sponsored by the U.S. Department of Labor. This led me to their "Career Profiles" section (US Department of Labor, 2025), where I reviewed general information about various occupations. I then used the "Occupation Profile" tool (US Department of Labor, 2025) to search for more specific data about marketing-related careers. Finally, I accessed the detailed occupation profile for "Marketing Managers" (US Department of Labor, 2025), which included information on job responsibilities, required education, salary ranges, employment outlook, and the role of communication in the field. This step-by-step process allowed me to gather accurate, government-backed information about the marketing profession and the types of writing commonly used in the industry. I once again returned to the VGCC Library's Career Exploration page, which offered links to trusted tools like ONET Online (VGCC, 2025). On ONET, I reviewed the summary for Marketing Managers, which described key tasks such as developing pricing strategies, analyzing market trends, and coordinating promotional efforts (National Center for ONET Development, 2025). This helped me better understand the skills and responsibilities required in the field.

Results

Marketing managers are responsible for developing pricing strategies, analyzing market trends, and coordinating promotional efforts to support business growth (US Department of Labor, 2025). The role requires strong communication skills and frequent collaboration with writers, designers, and analysts. Although the position is classified as a managerial role, it still involves a significant amount of detailed, hands-on work. One does not simply come up with campaigns or outreach strategies; they must actually build marketing techniques from the ground up. Mr Baxley put it like this: “You have to roll up your sleeves and do a lot of detailed dirty work, not thinking high-level strategy stuff” (Personal communication, November 10, 2025). ONET (2025) provides insight into the kinds of tools and software used on a daily basis to develop well-thought-out marketing campaigns. To name just a few, a marketer would need to learn how to use these kinds of software: “Customer relationship management CRM software... Database management system software... Database user interface and query software... Video creation and editing software... Web platform development software”. Mr. Baxley reflects on the sheer volume of marketing tools, commenting that “Now there are over 15,000 technologies” (Personal communication, November 10, 2025). Even with such a vast toolbox, marketers may still face pressure to use persuasive tactics that border on manipulation or target vulnerable audiences, raising ethical concerns that vary by industry and product focus.

A career in marketing is not solely about technology and strategy; it also involves a lot of writing. Mr. Baxley stresses multiple times that marketers need to have strong storytelling skills to succeed. When prompted on what kinds of writing a marketer does, Mr Baxley responds like this: “Writing is very important. That's a key role of Marketing, clearly communicating to prospects, customers, stakeholders of the company, and the market in general. Many aren't good

at it... but in the tech world you need to: a) avoid all the crazy jargon b) write clearly. c) use compelling stories that people can relate to” (Personal communication, November 10, 2025).

Given the complexity and demands of the role, it is important to understand the employment outlook, earning potential, and qualifications required to pursue a career in marketing management. According to ONET (2025), marketing managers are classified as a “Bright Outlook” occupation, meaning they are “projected to grow faster than average (employment increase of 6% or more)” and will have “large numbers of job openings” between 2023 and 2033 (National Center for ONET Development, 2025). Specifically, the U.S. Department of Labor (2025) reports that there will be “34,800 projected annual job openings”. In terms of compensation, CareerOneStop lists the median annual wage for marketing managers as “\$157,620,” with the highest earners making “\$239,200 or more” (US Department of Labor, 2025). To enter this field, candidates typically need a bachelor’s degree; CareerOneStop confirms that “most of these occupations require a four-year bachelor's degree” (US Department of Labor, 2025). Lastly, ONET emphasizes that successful marketing managers must possess skills in “active listening, critical thinking, and complex problem solving” (National Center for ONET Development, 2025).

Discussion

This research and interview confirmed that Marketing is the career path for me. Filled with strategy, teamwork, and technical design, marketing is the major I will pursue in and after college. I aspire to earn a major in marketing from the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill’s Kenan-Flagler Business School. Marketing can be a stressful field, but Mr. Baxely sums up all of his advise for aspiring marketers best when saying “Stay curious, constantly learn, be humble, work hard, be scrappy, seek out experienced people to get their advice/be a mentor, take

on different roles within a marketing organization/don't stay stuck in one role for many years or at one company. Take risks, be adventuresome.” (Personal communication, November 10, 2025). Baxley’s advice for aspiring marketers reinforces the importance of adaptability and initiative in the field. These words of encouragement, combined with the strong job outlook and high earning potentials, confirm that marketing is the right career path for me and motivate me to pursue the skills and experience needed to succeed.

References

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